

BuildTrack

The plan, in plain English

A short, easy-to-read summary of what BuildTrack is, who it's for and how it works. For the full detail, see the complete Product Requirements Document (PRD v1.0).

Document	Simple PRD (summary)
Product	BuildTrack (working name)
Version	1.0 — 27 September 2026
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1 What is BuildTrack?

BuildTrack is an app that lets people who are paying for a building project **see, check and approve the work remotely** — and gives the construction company **one place to run the project**.

In one sentence

You only count work as "done" when you've seen the proof and approved it — and every payment, message and decision is kept on record.

2 The problem

- **People can't see what's really happening on site.** A Nigerian living abroad who is building a house back home usually relies on a few WhatsApp photos and trust.
- **Money goes missing or gets argued about.** There's no clear record of what was paid, for which part of the work, or whether it was received.
- **WhatsApp isn't a record.** Chats get deleted, phones get lost, staff leave — and the history goes with them.
- **Good builders can't prove they're good.** Honest companies have no easy way to show a track record to new clients.
- **Existing software doesn't fit.** Big tools like Procore are expensive, complicated and built for large American companies, not for Nigerian builders and their clients.

3 Who uses it

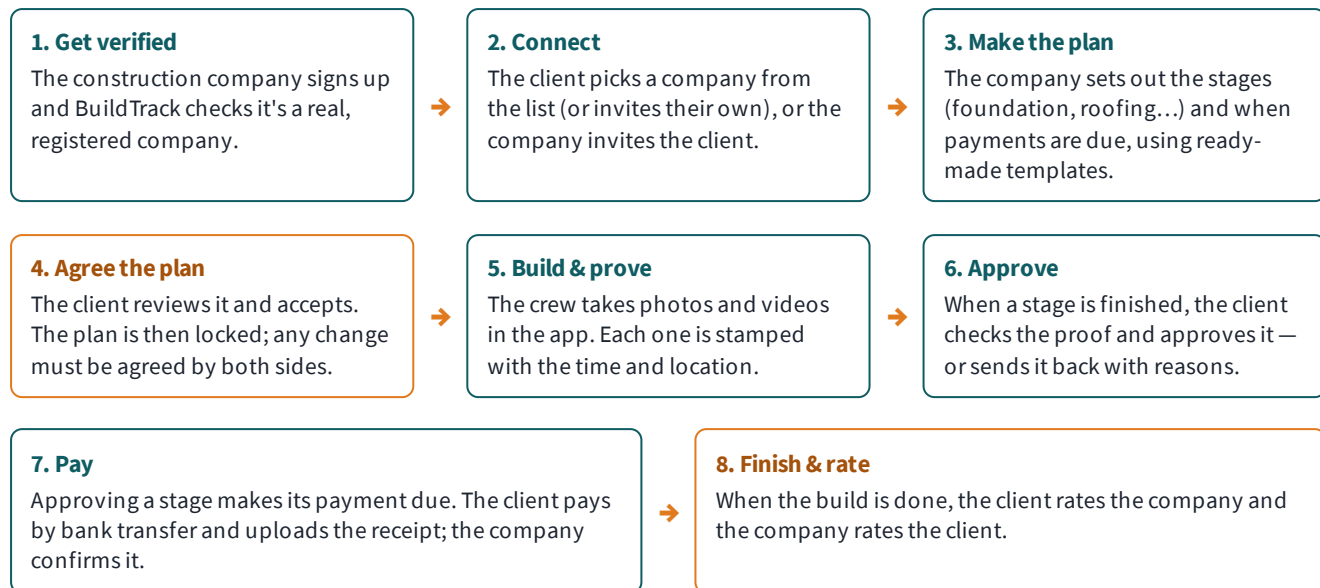
There are two sides: the **Client** (who pays for the build) and the **Contractor** (the company building it).

Side	Role	What they do
Client individuals, governments, companies	Client Admin	The person in charge. Approves the plan, approves work, records payments, rates the builder.
	Client Rep	Someone the Client Admin trusts to keep an eye on things for them (e.g. a relative near the site). The Client Admin chooses exactly what they're allowed to do.
Contractor	Director	Head of the construction company. Sees everything, manages staff, money and the company account.
	Site Manager	Runs the work on site, assigns tasks to the crew, posts progress and sends stages for approval.
	Office Coordinator	Handles the office side: documents, talking to clients, confirming payments.
	Crew Member	Workers on site. They see today's tasks and take photos and videos as proof.

Side	Role	What they do
BuildTrack	BuildTrack team	Checks that construction companies are genuine, helps users, manages the app.

Anyone else (family, a bank, the public) can be sent a read-only link to watch progress — they don't need an account.

4 How it works, step by step



5 Main features

Feature	In simple terms
Verified companies only	Companies must pass checks (CAC registration, tax number, director's ID, bank account in the company's name) before they can use the app.
Stage templates	Ready-made lists of stages for every type of project — bungalows, duplexes, commercial buildings, roads, bridges and more.
Proof you can trust	Photos and videos taken in the app carry the time and location. Each stage needs a minimum amount of proof before it can be sent for approval.
Real progress	The progress percentage only counts stages the client has approved — not just what the builder says.
Payment records	What's due, what's paid, receipts and confirmations — all in one place.
Built-in chat	WhatsApp-style chat inside the app for the company's staff and its clients, so conversations stay with the project.
Notifications	Phone alerts for important things (mostly app notifications, email when action is needed, SMS only for urgent things).

Feature	In simple terms
Ratings	Clients rate companies and companies rate clients. Unresolved disputes show on both profiles.
Worker rewards (optional)	Staff earn points for good, approved work, which the company can turn into bonuses.
Works offline	Crew can take proof with no signal; it uploads automatically later.
Web and mobile	Both clients and companies can use a website and a phone app.

6 How money and disagreements are handled

In the first version, **money does not go through the app**. People pay by normal bank transfer, and the app keeps the record.

- **Paying:** when a payment is due, the client sees the company's bank details, pays, then uploads the receipt with the transaction reference.
- **Confirming:** the company has **3 days** to confirm it received the money, or dispute it. If it says nothing, the payment is marked "Paid – not confirmed by contractor".
- **Protection against fraud:** only the company's Director can change its bank account, the account name must match the registered company name, clients are alerted immediately, and payments pause for **48 hours** after any change.
- **Disagreements:** either side can open a dispute about a payment or a piece of work. The project pauses, both sides add evidence, and both must agree it's resolved. If it isn't sorted within **14 days**, it shows as "Unresolved dispute" on both profiles.
- **Slow clients:** if a client doesn't review a stage, they get reminders. After **7 days** it's marked overdue and the company can carry on — the delay is shown as the client's.

7 What makes BuildTrack different

- **Built for the client, not just the builder** — clients have real power to approve work.
- **Progress is proven, not just reported.**
- **Payments are tied to approved work** and every step is on record.
- **Only genuine, checked companies** — and clients verify their identity too, so nobody can escape a bad reputation.
- **Made for Nigeria** — naira by default, works on low-cost Android phones and poor network, uses local terms (DPC, intel, decking).

8 How BuildTrack makes money

Who	Pays?
Construction companies	Yes — a monthly or yearly subscription based on how many projects they're running at once. Their first project is free until it's finished (up to 12 months). Unlimited staff.
Individual clients	Free, always.
Governments & organisations	Free during "Early Access" at launch; a paid plan comes later.

Actual prices will be decided later.

9 What comes when

Release	What's included
First launch	Everything described above: verification, projects, stage templates, proof, approvals, payment records, disputes, chat, notifications, ratings, share links, worker rewards, web + mobile apps.
Soon after	Pausing or cancelling a project, switching to a new company mid-build, tracking expenses and materials.
Version 2	Paying directly through the app, BuildTrack helping settle disputes, paid plans for organisations, more than one company per project.
Later	Money held safely until work is approved (escrow), independent site inspections, camera and drone support.

10 Still to decide

- The final name (BuildTrack is a working name).
- Subscription prices.
- Reward system details (how often points are totalled, limits on bonus points).
- Which outside services to use (for ID checks, SMS, email and billing).

— End —